

Michael Kotrous

Ph.D. Candidate
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University of Georgia

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Education

Ph.D. Economics, University of Georgia, 2021–Present (expected August 2027)
M.A. Economics, University of Georgia, 2023
B.A. Economics and Journalism (*summa cum laude*), Creighton University, 2015

Research Fields and Interests Industrial organization, labor economics; franchising, broadband

Job Market Paper

- [1] “The Effect of Municipal Broadband on Labor Markets: Evidence from Chattanooga, TN”

Refereed Journal Articles

- [2] “Broadband Speeds in Fibered U.S. Markets: An Empirical Analysis” with James Bailey, 2021, *Journal of Information Policy* 11: 478–522.
[3] “The Benefits of Coronavirus Suppression: A Cost-Benefit Analysis of the Response to the First Wave of COVID-19 in the United States” with James Broughel, 2021, *PLOS ONE* 16(6): e0252729.

Works in Progress

- [4] “The Labor Market Effects of No-Poach Clauses in the Quick-Service Restaurant Industry”
[5] “Multi-Unit Ownership in U.S. Fast Food Franchising” with Peter Newberry

Conference and Seminar Presentations

- 2025 “The Labor Market Effects of No-Poach Clauses in the Quick-Service Restaurant Industry,” Southern Economic Association (SEA) Meeting
2024 “Multi-Unit Ownership & No-Poach Clauses in U.S. Fast Food,” SEA Meeting
2021 “Broadband Speeds in Fibered Markets: An Empirical Analysis,” TPRC/48th Research Conference on Communication, Information and Internet Policy
2020 “The Effect of the FCC’s High-Cost Program on the Extensive and Intensive Margin of Rural Broadband Deployment,” Rural Digital Divide Roundtable, Nebraska College of Law
2019 “The Nature & Effects of the Emergence of Online Intermediated Work,” The Future of Work Conference, Mercatus Center at George Mason University and Niskanen Center
2016 “Gigabit Fiber Networks & Speed Competition in the U.S.,” The Institute for Humane Studies
2015 “Economic Growth & Income Inequality: A Public Choice Analysis,” SEA Meeting
“The Effects of Non-Neutral Network Management Policies on the Price and Diffusion of Broadband in the Developing World,” Economics Scholars Program Conference for Undergraduate Research, Federal Reserve Bank of Dallas

Awards, Fellowships, and Grants

Swift Undergraduate Teaching Fellowship, Department of Economics, University of Georgia, 2025
Outstanding TA Award, Center for Teaching and Learning, University of Georgia, 2025
Graduate School Domestic Travel Grants, University of Georgia, 2024 and 2025
Bastiat Fellowship, Mercatus Center at George Mason University, 2021–2022
Carl Menger Essay Award, Society for the Development of Austrian Economics, 2015
Omicron Delta Epsilon, Creighton University, 2015
Werner-Robertson Fellowship, Institute for Economic Inquiry, Creighton University, 2014–2015

Teaching Experience

Instructor of Record

Intermediate Macroeconomics, University of Georgia	Fa 2026
Sports Economics, University of Georgia	Fa 2026
Survey of Economics (<i>online, asynchronous</i>), Coastal Carolina University	Fa 2026
Principles of Macroeconomics, University of Georgia	Su 2024

Teaching Assistant, University of Georgia

Macroeconomic Theory (Ph.D.)	Fa 2022–Sp 2026
Economic Analysis for Business Leaders (M.B.A.)	Fa 2023
Senior Thesis (Undergraduate)	Sp 2022
Principles of Microeconomics (Undergraduate Honors)	Fa 2021–Sp 2022

Research and Professional Experience

Economics and Finance Quality Control Auditor, Scale AI, San Francisco, CA, 2025–Present
Summer Research Assistant for Peter Newberry, University of Georgia, Athens, GA, 2023–2025
Analyst, JPinkse LLC, State College, PA, 2023–2024
Program Manager, Mercatus Center at George Mason University, Arlington, VA, 2016–2021

Selected Policy Publications & Commentary

- [1] “Rural Broadband Deployment in Florida: Recommendations for Reform” with Brent Skorup, *The Journal of the James Madison Institute* 64, Fall 2021
- [2] “Narrowing the Rural Digital Divide with Consumer Vouchers” with Brent Skorup, Mercatus Center, Oct. 2020
- [3] “Why Economists Measure Human Lives in Dollars” with James Broughel, *POLITICO*, Apr. 2020
- [4] “Quantifying Regulation in U.S. States” with James Broughel & Patrick McLaughlin, Mercatus Center, Nov. 2019

Professional Service

Referee Activity

Center for Growth and Opportunity at Utah State University

Conference Discussant

Southern Economic Association Meeting (2024, 2025)
Western Economic Association Virtual International Conference (2021)

Technical Skills MATLAB, Python, R, Stata

References

Peter Newberry (chair)
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University of Georgia
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Jeff Thurk
Principal Economist
Amazon Web Services
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Meghan Skira
Sara and Dan Boyd Professor
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Roozbeh Hosseini (teaching reference)
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